

Next Meeting:
May 1, 2011
With special guest speaker:
Cliff DelCarlo
Mtn. View Fire Dept. History
See Page 2

The Register-Leader

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION NEWSLETTER

Volume I *Issue 1* *Spring 2011*

Highlights:

New Life for an Old House



The past & future of one of Mtn. View's oldest homes.
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Mtn. View Memories



Share your Mtn. View Memories!
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President's Message

By Patricia Figueroa
MVHA President

One of my goals as the President of the Mountain Historical Association was to work with the Newsletter Editor to change the format of our newsletter and present new options to our members.

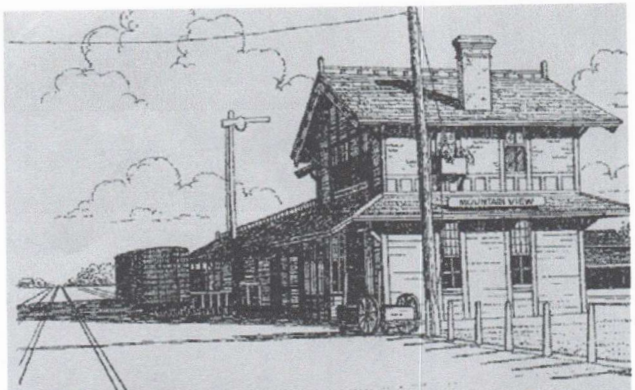
Nick Perry, our new Newsletter Editor has done that. Nick is a 4th generation Mountain View Resident who has also written a book about Mountain View. He has made changes in our Newsletter that we hope will encourage more of you to share your memories with us. Verbal history is even more important than "things".

Explore the options this new newsletter offers for members to share their memories of the history of Mountain View and don't hesitate to share with us your thoughts about the new format. The changes made are meant to not only give you more information but also to let you receive that information in whatever way is the most comfortable for you.

Don't forget to put on you calendar May 1st for our next General Membership meeting at Adobe House and at the same time "save the date" of August 7th when we will again be putting on our fantastic annual barbecue.

See you on May 1st!

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION - P.O. Box 252 - Mountain View, Ca 94042
Visit us on-line at www.mountainviewhistorical.org



The Register-Leader

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MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, Ca 94042
www.mountainviewhistorical.org

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Programs: Bob Weaver
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Hospitality: Helene Hughes
Memorial & Remembrances: Hip Telemont
Ways & Means: Richard Espinosa
Historical Data: Barbara Kinchen
Boardmember-at-Large: Nick Galiotto

Become a Member Today!

See Page 9 on how to join!

In Memoriam

Lorris Watson
September 7, 1919 ~ January 4, 2011

News & Notes

May Meeting Preview

By Bob Weaver
Programs Officer

Pending Article. Placeholder text. Quis expeliquat. Um accus, necte mo endenis et inti dolupta cor audis pra velis explabore comnis aspit, conse audipsa ndeliam qui aliatia ndioria core optatem ut eum iuris nihitio. Accae doluptas doleni vellant emporep roreiciis eum quaspide nus adit maio volupta ab inum aniae. Nem hilique illis por sintur, cus dolupic to molorrum vendae nam quam ut il magnia et volecat hitatur?
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The New Newsletter

By Nick Perry
Newsletter Editor

Hello everyone! For those of you don't know me, my name is Nick Perry and I'm the new editor of the Association's newsletter. I'm very happy to take on this role, and look forward to working with you all on this publication.

As you've probably noticed, the newsletter has been given a top-down design makeover. In addition to the new look, it has a new name; "The Register-Leader" in honor of Mountain View's long-time hometown paper, "The Mountain View-Register Leader." Despite these changes, the function of the newsletter remains the same: to provide quarterly updates on MVHA's activities and to provide a forum to share stories and information on our local history.

As we move forward with plans for a History Museum and continue public outreach efforts, my hope is that this newsletter will help build more excitement and awareness of Mountain View's history and the numerous ways this organization is working towards ensuring this city's history is preserved for future generations.

Your feedback and contributions will be key to its success, just e-mail me at, **mvha.newsletter@gmail.com.** I hope you enjoy this first edition of the "The Register-Leader"!

New to the History Center

By Barbara Kinchen
Historical Data Officer

From member Eleanor McGlynn Henderson

- Seven Mountain View High School Yearbooks, 1936-39
- One San Jose State College Yearbook, 1941
- Scrapbook of snapshots of reunions for 1940-42 graduates of Mountain View High School. John Viscovich was keeping this current.

From member John Tomac

- Small display case with Mr. Tomac's badges and insignia from his police department service
- Copy of booklet by Tomac, The Mountain View Police 1912-1972
- War Stories - an Oral History of the Mountain View Police Department by Doug Johnson
- Historical Roster of Mountain View Police Department 1902-2010

MVHA Financial Report

By John Figueroa
Treasurer

Checking Account Balance as of 12/31/11: $ 8,821.73

- Income: $ ~~13,200.80~~ 4379.07
- Expenses: $ 332.06

Checking Account Balance as of 3/16/11: $ 12,868.74

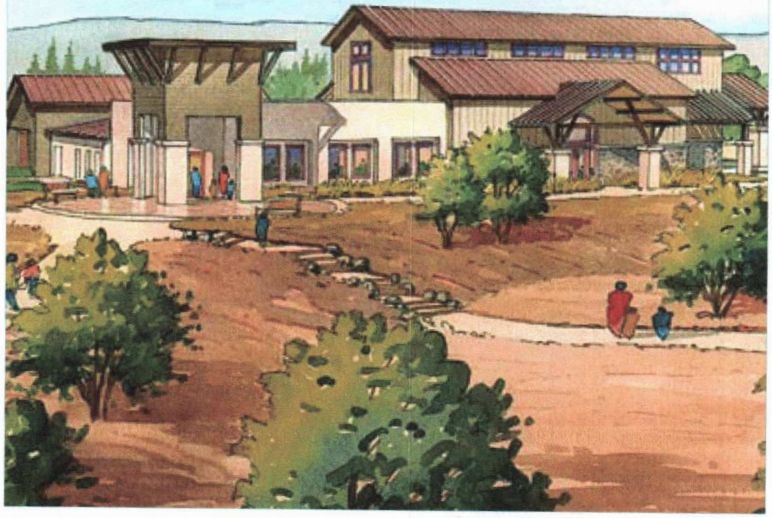
Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 3/16/11: $78,873.02

- Including $ 31,037.86 designated for the Museum.

Museum Update

www.mountainviewhistorical/museum

For the Latest Information
on MVHA's Museum Planning Efforts!



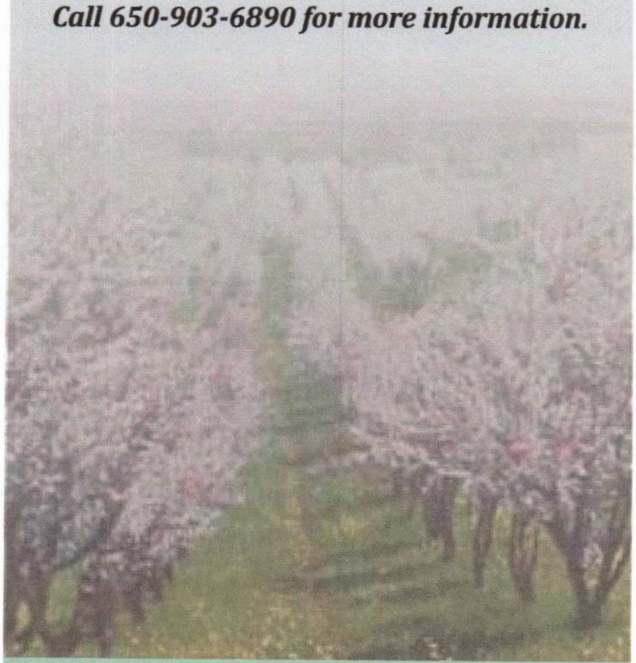
About the History Center

The Mountain View History Center's mission is to collect, organize and make available Mountain View historical resources and to promote the city's heritage. It contains the historic archives of both the Mountain View Historical Association and the Mountain View Public Library. Historical books and pamphlets on the history of Mountain View are also available for purchase at the History Center.

Location:
Mountain View Public Library, 2nd Floor
585 Franklin Street
Mountain View, CA 94041

Hours:
The history center is open to the general public from 1-5pm every Tuesday, and by appointment.

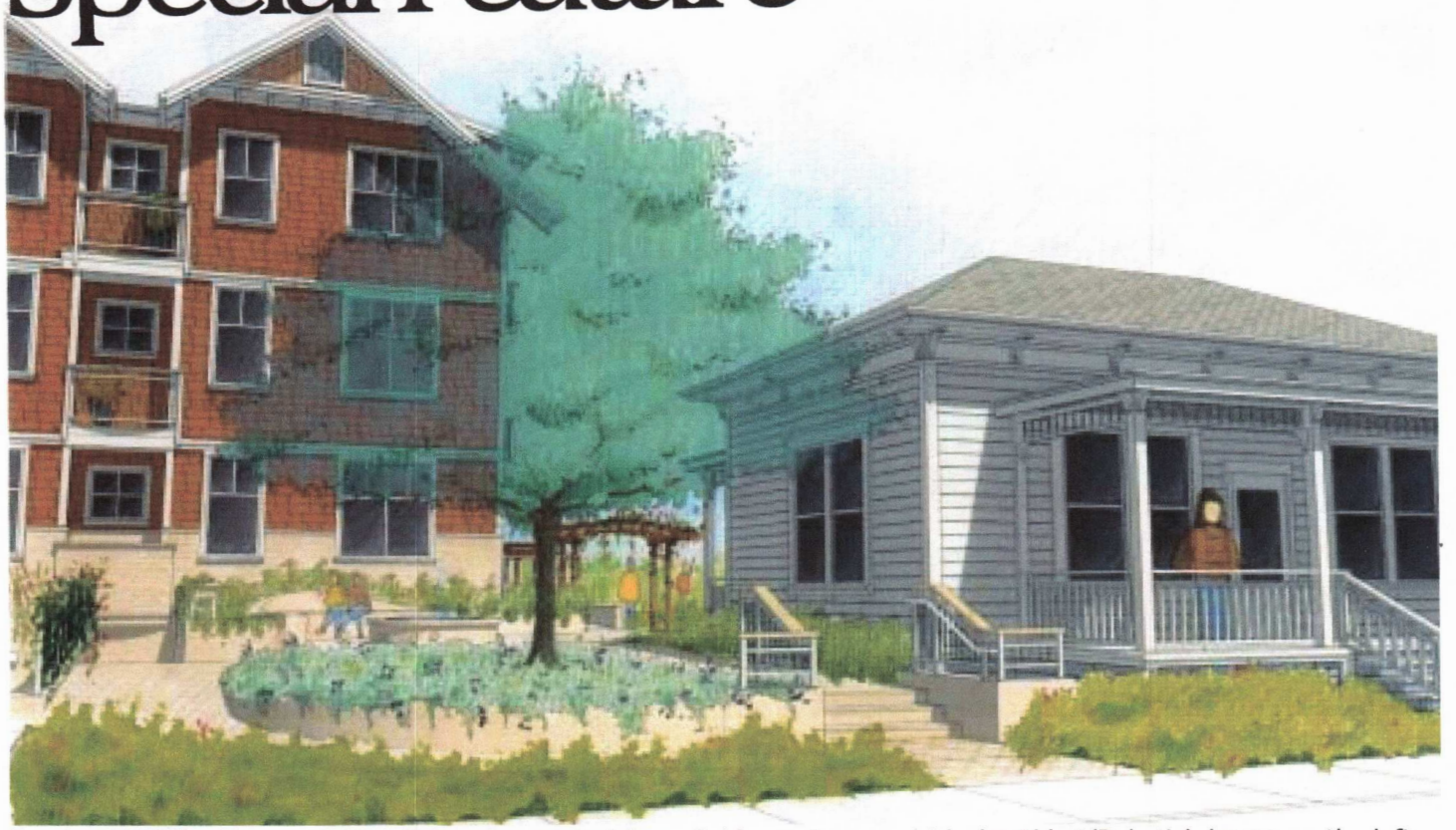
Call 650-903-6890 for more information.



Go Green!
See the Newsletter in
FULL COLOR

Save paper and resources by e-mailing us at *mvha.newsletter@gmail.com* to receive the newsletter as an Adobe PDF.

Special Feature



Rendering of the Mountain View Cohousing Project from Calderon Avenue, with the Abbot/Bakotich house on the left
Courtesy Mountain View Cohousing Community

New Life for an Old House

By Susan Burwen
Member of the Mountain View Cohousing Community

Susan Burwen, member of the Mountain View Cohousing Community, shares with us the history of the Abbot/Bakotich House at 445 Calderon Avenue, and her group's plans for the property's future.

The farmhouse located at 445 Calderon Avenue sits on land purchased by a group of local residents who want to create the first Cohousing Community in Mountain View. Cohousing is a type of collaborative housing in which residents are consciously committed to living as a community, actively participating in the design and operation of their own neighborhood.

We envision the Mountain View Cohousing Community as a new 'old-fashioned' neighborhood consisting of 19 energy-efficient condominium homes plus common facilities for shared activities. Parking will be underground to maximize open space in a park-like setting with a garden, orchard and network of pedestrian pathways.

The farmhouse will be an integral part of our community. It was originally constructed in 1885 by Charles Abbot, making it ones of the oldest homes in Mountain View. At the time, Calderon Avenue was a rural street and the house was surrounded by a 12-acre plot planted with apricot, walnut, and cherry trees. Remnants of the walnut orchard are still visible, although the trees are no longer viable. In 1926, the house was purchased by the Bakotich family. Ann Bakotich, born in 1917, grew up in the house and lived there until she passed away in 2007. Many residents of the Old Mountain View Neighborhood have fond memories of Ann.

New Life for an Old House (continued from page 4)

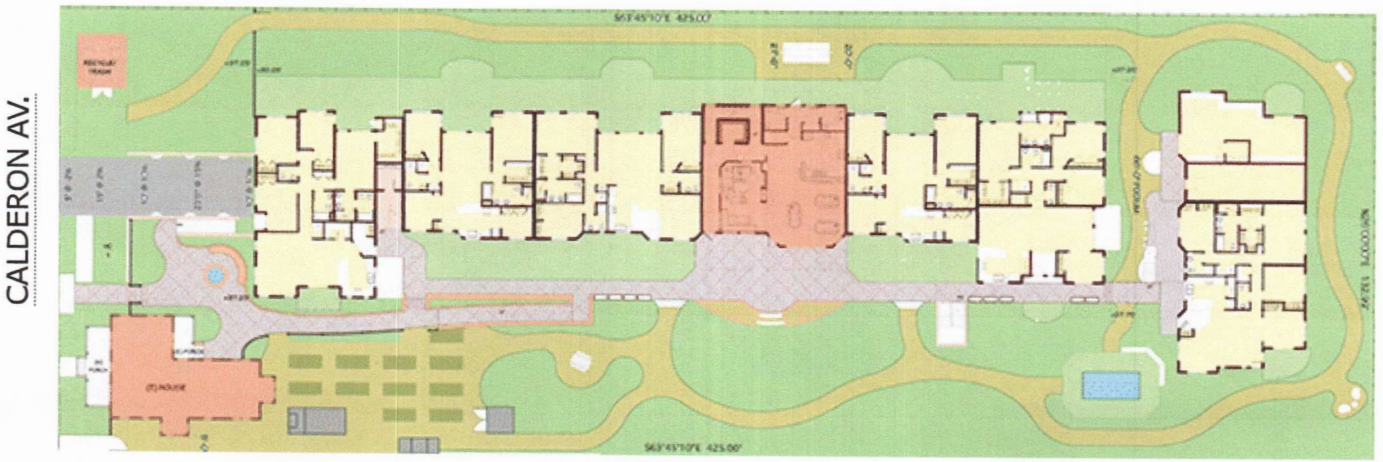
Over the years, several changes to the property have taken place. The farmhouse was moved an unknown distance sometime between 1926 and 1956, relocated from elsewhere on the original 12 acre parcel to its current location. Its original orientation on the site is unknown. In the early 1950s, the original 12 acre parcel was subdivided and sold off, including the land now occupied by Landels School as well as the adjacent apartment buildings. Besides relocation, the farmhouse itself has undergone several alterations including additions to the rear of the building and replacement of original parts.

Looking toward the future, we plan to make the farmhouse an integral part of the Mountain View Cohousing Community. It will be used as a gathering place to share community activities and for accommodations for guests and a possible future on-site caregiver. In its present form and location, the house does not contribute to the neighborhood—it is barely visible in its present setting. Our plans for incorporating the farmhouse into our community include:

- Rotating the house 90 degrees clockwise from its present orientation and relocating it to the southwest corner of the property. The façade with the existing front porch and original front door will face Calderon Avenue. It will be placed in a park-like setting visible to the neighborhood.
- Removing the addition at the back of the building that was not part of the original farmhouse.
- Reconfiguring the back of the original farmhouse, by removing 11 feet and reusing the original siding, windows, moldings, and trim to enclose the hole made by the removal of the addition. In this way, the characteristics of the exterior of this simple farmhouse, with light touches of Victorian flourish in the details and materials, will be preserved.
- Restoring the hip roof, that was altered when the addition was put on, to its original configuration, by moving the hip back and removing the flat part of the roof that was not part of the original house. This preserves the original roof overhang, eave and bracket design.

Not only is most of the farmhouse being retained and rehabilitated, it will be devoted to a lasting and valuable use; it will have a new life and purpose as a vital part of our cohousing community. Historical consultants refer to this as "adaptive reuse" and value it highly as a means of merging the past and the future.

With the original front porch and front door facing Calderon Avenue, the Old Mountain View Neighborhood will now be able to see and enjoy this house in a well-landscaped park-like setting. The farmhouse offers a wonderful interface between the neighborhood and our cohousing community, providing a link between past and future.



Site Plan for the Mountain View Co-Housing Project, with the Abbot/Bakotich house in the lower left corner
Courtesy Mountain View Cohousing Community

Mtn. View Memories

My Memories of Life on Church Street

By John Brazil

Grandma and Grandpa had an orchard on the corner of Church Street and Calderon Avenue. Orchards on Church Street? It was approximately two acres with apricots and an old tall two story home with a high screened porch.

John J. Silveira and his wife Caroline lived there with their three daughters. The girls played violin and mandolin. After my Mother died, I discovered her mandolin and music. I learned to play the "mando."

During the 1950s the property was sold to the Fritz family. The old two-story home was torn down and we used some of the brick and lumber to build a home on Jessie Lane. That's being green.

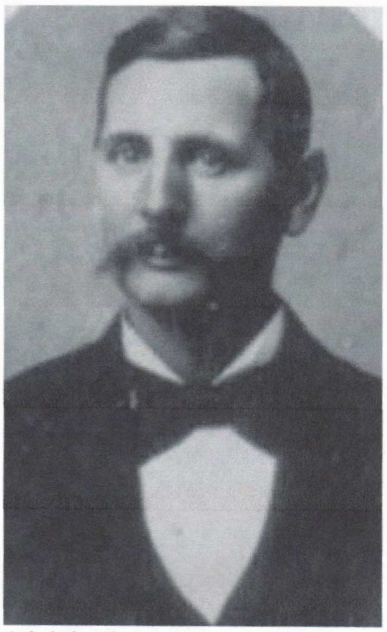
We always wondered how Grandpa acquired property in three countries. When visiting his home on Church Street I remembered seeing a still in the barn. Now I know. That's another story...

Share Your Mountain View Memories! E-mail submissions to:
***mvha.newsletter@gmail.com** or mail them to:*
MVHA Newsletter, 1546 W. Dana St. Mtn. View, CA 94041.
Photo submissions welcomed!
Submissions may be edited for length and clarity.

Street Talk



By Barbara Kinchen
Historical Data Officer



Adolph Ehrhorn
1897 Mtn. View Cyclers Club Photo

In 1883 Mrs. Louisa Marie Ehrhorn of San Francisco bought property in Mountain View. Over 30 acres, it was bounded by Castro Street, Church Street, Calderon Avenue and El Camino Real. The land was soon planted with fruit trees.

Mrs. Ehrhorn was a widow with a large family. She died in Mountain View in 1903. Son Adolph William Ehrhorn lived on the orchard property until 1918 when he moved his family to Alviso Road, north of the railroad.

Sales and development of the El Camino property eventually resulted in three subdivisions: Nelson Manor on the West, Ehrhorn Tract on the East, and the large center portion was the Glumaz Subdivision.

Hope, View and Bush Streets were extended from Church Street to El Camino. In 1923, a new street, Ehrhorn Avenue, was laid out in the Ehrhorn Tract. At that time lots along Ehrhorn Avenue and Calderon were selling for $8.00 "per front foot". Terms were 15% cash down and 36 monthly payments at 8% interest.

Membership

Membership Report

By June Casey
Membership Officer

Membership as of March 15, 2011

Honored Members	2
Life Members	116
Family Members	70
Single Members	108
TOTAL MEMBERSHIP	**296**

Welcome to our new members!

- Nellie C. Calvo, Jessica R. Casey, Roberta Jorgensen,
- Dona H. Dodson, **Life Member**

Join us today!

The Mountain View Historical Association welcomes new members. Any person who signifies interest in the aims of the Association and who pays the specified dues may become a member. The aims of the Mountain View Historical Association are:

- To gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View.
- To collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area
- To preserve historic objects and places
- To cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worth by our membership

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

Membership Application & Renewal Form

☐ New membership

☐ Renewal

☐ REGULAR MEMBER: *$10/year*

☐ FAMILY MEMBER: *$15/year*

☐ LIFE TIME MEMBER: *$200*

☐ *Contact me for Volunteer opportunities*

NAME: _____

ADDRESS: _____

_____

CITY: _____

TELEPHONE _____

E-MAIL _____

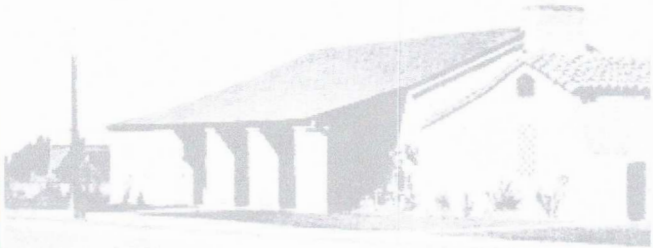
Please make checks payable to:
Mountain View Historical Association

Mail to:
Mountain View Historical Association
PO Box 252, Mountain View, Ca 94042

Spring '11 Calender

SPRING 2011
General Membership Meeting
Sunday, May 1, 2011 at 2PM
Doors Open at 1:30, General Public Welcome!

Featuring a talk by:
Cliff DelCarlo
Mountain View Fire Department History



At the historic
Adobe Building
157 Moffett Boulevard at Central Expressway
(Parking in the rear off Central Avenue)

May 1, 2011
MVHA General Membership Meeting
Adobe Building, 2pm
See Page 2 for more info

May 22, 2011
Living History Celebration &
20th Anniversary of the Rengstorff House
Rengstorff House, 11am-5pm

Save the Date:
August 6, 2011
MVHA Annual Barbeque
More information in our Summer newsletter!



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FIRST CLASS MAIL

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